

PROZO LOGISTICS — HR & COMPLIANCE INTERN

Pan-India warehouse compliance, executed end to end

Shop & Establishment registrations, CLRA Principal Employer registrations, and Contract Labour licences across 36+ warehouses and offices in 5 states — owned from regulatory mapping through final approval.

36+

Warehouses & offices

5

States covered

90+

Licences filed

~80

Approvals received

2

Months duration

REPORTING LINE

Senior Director of HR (direct) — CEO's office kept in loop

FORMAT

HR & Compliance Case Study

— CONTEXT & PROBLEM

A distributed network with a compliance gap

Prozo runs a distributed warehouse network across India. Every facility — warehouse or office — must hold valid Shop & Establishment registration, CLRA Principal Employer registration, and Contract Labour licences under the CLRA Act, 1970.

When I joined, a significant share of these registrations were pending, due for renewal, or not yet initiated for newly operational locations — across 36+ sites in 5 states.

Maharashtra

Haryana

Uttar Pradesh

Telangana

Karnataka

RISK

Operating without valid S&E, CLRA, or Contract Labour licences exposes the company to regulatory penalties, labour audits, and operational shutdowns.

COMPLEXITY

Each state runs a different portal, document checklist, fee structure, and approval timeline. No single process worked across all locations.

SCALE

36+ locations with varying headcounts, lease agreements, and business categories — each requiring 2 to 3 individual licence applications.

OWNERSHIP

End-to-end responsibility was assigned to me, reporting directly to the Senior Director of HR, with the CEO's office kept in loop at every stage.

2–3

Applications required per individual location

6

Internal teams supplying data — Finance, Legal, HR, IT, Ops, Admin

5

Separate government portals, each with its own rules

0

Standard process that worked the same way twice

— WHAT WAS BEING FILED

Three licence types, every facility

Each warehouse and office needed its own set — none transferable across locations, none optional.

Shop & Establishment (S&E) Registration	Mandatory for every commercial establishment. Governs working hours, leave, wages, and employee rights. Each warehouse and office requires its own individual registration under the respective state Act.
CLRA Principal Employer Registration	Required under the Contract Labour (Regulation and Abolition) Act, 1970, for any establishment employing 20 or more contract workers. Prozo, as the principal employer, must hold this registration before engaging any contractor at a facility.
Contract Labour Licence	Issued to contractors deploying contract workers at Prozo facilities. The principal employer is responsible for ensuring contractors hold valid licences and for maintaining Form V (principal employer certificate) for each contractor engagement.

CUTTING ACROSS ALL THREE FILINGS			
Identity & Entity	Facility Proof	Workforce Data	Site Verification
PAN, GST, TAN, incorporation documents, board resolutions	Lease agreements, utility bills, NOCs, occupancy certificates	Headcount, contract worker details, Form V documentation	Geo-tagged facility photos and videos, floor area details

— MY APPROACH — PART 1

Research and mapping, before any filing

01 Platform Research & Portal Familiarisation

Studied the relevant government portal for each state — Aaple Sarkar (Maharashtra), eKarmika (Karnataka), Nivesh Mitra (Uttar Pradesh), the Telangana Labour Department portal, and Shram Suvidha (central and Haryana). Understood each portal's UI, document specs, and fee flow before initiating any application.

02 Regulatory Mapping — State by State

Built a state-wise compliance matrix documenting applicable Acts, mandatory documents per licence type, worker headcount thresholds, renewal cycles, fee structures, and competent authority contacts — the single reference document for every filing.

03 Internal Data Collection & Stakeholder Coordination

Raised structured data requests across Finance (PAN, GST, TAN, fee challans), Legal (incorporation docs, signatory details), HR (headcount, contractor data, Form V), IT (digital signatures, portal access), Warehouse Ops (geo-tagged photos, floor details), and Admin (utility bills, NOCs).

— MY APPROACH — PART 2

From documents to approved licences

04 Information Funnel & Document Compilation

Built a master tracker mapping each warehouse to its required documents, collection status, responsible contact, and submission deadline. Documents were validated against state checklists, reformatted to meet upload constraints, and organised into location-wise folders before submission.

05 Application Filing & Portal Execution

Filed applications across all three licence categories sequentially, prioritising states with longer approval TATs. Each warehouse required a minimum of 2, sometimes 3, separate applications — resulting in 90+ total filings across 36+ locations.

06 Approval Tracking & TAT Management

Maintained a live approval TAT tracker logging submission date, expected approval date, current status, authority queries, and follow-up actions — with regular updates to the Senior Director of HR and the CEO's office.

— KEY CHALLENGES

Where the process actually broke

c1 Portal Instability & Document Size Limits

- State portals crashed frequently under load, causing mid-session data loss and repeated re-entry.
- Upload limits of 1–5 MB clashed with source files like lease deeds running 20–30 pages.
- Compressing files degraded quality below the portal's AI-readability threshold.

RESOLUTION

Built a document workflow that selectively reduced resolution on non-critical pages while preserving legibility on signature and stamp pages. Saved progress at every stage to avoid crash-related losses.

c2 Cross-Functional Data Dependencies

- Each application needed inputs from Finance, Legal, HR, IT, Warehouse Ops, and Admin — with no central repository.
- Teams had varying response times and differing awareness of compliance urgency.
- 36+ locations meant tracking hundreds of individual document statuses concurrently.

RESOLUTION

Created a structured data request format per state and location, with clear deadlines and specs. A master tracker enabled systematic follow-up without duplication or missed items.

— KEY CHALLENGES — CONTINUED

AI-gated verification and geo-tagging

C3 AI-Gated Portal Verification & Geo-Tagging Requirements

- Several portals used AI-based document verification that auto-rejected uploads with poor clarity, wrong formats, or missing metadata.
- Facility videos and photos required embedded GPS metadata to validate the physical warehouse address — undocumented anywhere in the portal instructions.
- A failed upload triggered a mandatory 2–3 hour cooldown before resubmission, directly impacting timelines.

RESOLUTION

Researched and implemented geo-tagging methods to manually embed GPS coordinates into facility media before upload. Introduced a pre-submission internal review step to catch errors before portal submission, minimising cooldown delays.

— OUTPUT SNAPSHOT

36+

Warehouses & offices, across 5 states

90+

Total applications filed

~80

Licences approved within tenure

7–8

Pending at handover, within normal TAT

— OUTPUT & IMPACT

What got filed, tracked, and approved

The full reference record — licence types, reporting line, portals used, and what was handed over.

LICENCE TYPES HANDLED	S&E Registration, CLRA Principal Employer Registration, Contract Labour Licence
TOTAL APPLICATIONS FILED	90+ filings — a minimum of 2, often 3 applications per location
APPROVALS RECEIVED	Approximately 80 licences approved within internship tenure
PENDING AT HANDOVER	7 to 8 applications in process, within normal authority TAT
REPORTING LINE	Senior Director of HR (direct); CEO's office kept in loop at every stage
STATE PORTALS USED	Aaple Sarkar (MH), eKarmika (KA), Nivesh Mitra (UP), Telangana Labour Dept portal (TG), Shram Suvidha (HR + central)
DOCUMENTATION DELIVERED	Audit-ready filing folders, state-wise compliance matrix, live approval TAT tracker

— KEY LEARNINGS

Five things this project taught me

Process before execution

Investing time upfront in research and state-wise mapping reduced errors downstream and saved far more time than diving straight into portal submissions.

Coordination is a skill, not a given

Managing data dependencies across Finance, Legal, HR, IT, Warehouse Operations, and Admin simultaneously required structured communication with clear formats and deadlines, not just follow-up messages.

Technical problem-solving is part of HR compliance

Geo-tagging facility media, navigating AI-gated portals, and managing document compression workflows are not typical HR tasks — but full ownership of the problem required learning each of them.

Regulatory frameworks are not uniform

Each state's interpretation and implementation of central labour laws varies significantly. The state-wise compliance matrix built at the start was the single most valuable artefact of the project.

Accuracy over speed

In compliance, a rejected application means a 2 to 3 hour cooldown, lost time, and regulatory risk. Slowing down to verify each document before submission was consistently faster than rushing and resubmitting.

PROZO LOGISTICS

**36+ locations. 5 states. One process,
built to hold up under audit.**

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2026